

Leewel Mwangi

Senior Software Engineer | Full-Stack Product Engineer

Nairobi, Kenya · +254 704 591 667 · leewelkarani@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/leewelmwangi

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior software engineer with seven years of production experience across fintech, telecom, public-service platforms and real-time communication. I work across frontend architecture, backend and API integration, technical design, testing, releases and production troubleshooting — taking a change from an unclear request through to what happens after it is deployed. I use AI tools daily to understand unfamiliar systems, plan and review changes, and verify what reaches production.

WORK EXPERIENCE

AI-First Software Engineer | Skyvera | Remote

Jul 2025 – Apr 2026

- Delivered change requests and production defect fixes across the enterprise order-management and CRM systems of a European telecommunications operator, working with a distributed engineering and business team.
- Clarified what was actually being asked before building — separating support questions from defects and genuine change requests, sizing real scope against the reported scope, and deciding when to investigate, escalate or de-escalate with technical and business stakeholders.
- Contributed to high- and low-level designs, implementation plans and release documentation, identifying technical trade-offs, bottlenecks and single points of failure before a change was built.
- Traced behaviour across frontends, APIs, repositories and connected platforms to separate environment, configuration, data, integration and application failures — including reverse-engineering unfamiliar deployments to confirm which build was actually running before debugging it.
- Carried changes through SIT and UAT into production deployment, then owned them afterwards: monitoring, regression handling and the fixes that followed.
- Built and maintained the Playwright browser-test architecture used across seven enterprise CRM modules — page objects, deterministic waits, environment-aware execution, and test data managed as infrastructure.
- Used Claude and Cursor daily to read unfamiliar codebases, decompose and plan work, review generated code, and verify frontend, backend and API behaviour before release.

Senior Software Engineer | Neostream Technology Group | Nairobi

Mar 2023 – Jun 2025

- Led the design and implementation of a Java USSD proof of concept for a tier-one Kenyan bank, integrating with REST APIs and optimising menu flows for accessibility on low-end handsets.
- Built a high-performance web dashboard in Node.js and React, including API integration and debugging, to improve task completion for operational users.
- Audited and redesigned a business banking platform, then delivered that design into an established React monorepo — information architecture, money movement, transactions and card administration, authored as separate desktop and mobile compositions.
- Led UAT and production release validation for an agricultural banking solution, supporting a controlled rollout of core banking features.
- Partnered with cross-functional stakeholders on a data governance framework and fraud prevention initiatives.

Software Engineer | Fingo (Y Combinator S21) | Nairobi

Jan 2021 – Feb 2023

- Core React Native contributor on the mobile app of a Y Combinator-backed neobank, joining early while the product and its priorities were still being decided.
- Built savings "pots" — the flows customers use to set money aside and take it back out — and transaction reversals, from the screen a user sees through to the history it has to agree with.
- Rebuilt profile and security forms around biometrics and PIN, and shipped in-app notifications with an embedded support chat.

- Implemented product analytics instrumentation that informed feature decisions, and a proactive outage notification system so customers heard about downtime rather than discovering it.
- Worked beyond the frontend brief where the team needed it, in a regulated environment where mistakes cost people money.

Lead Frontend Engineer | Ideas Come to Life Limited | Nairobi

Oct 2019 – Jan 2021

- Led frontend architecture and UI/UX design from scratch, building the foundation of ChatSasa and the company's conversational AI products.
- Engineered the ChatSasa React SDK — real-time transport over WebSockets and Centrifugo, with presence, delivery and read receipts, reactions and paginated history — and published it to npm as chatsasa-react-sdk with TypeScript types shipped alongside the build.
- Designed every message state as interface rather than as an afterthought: typed, sent, delivered, read, failed and recovered.
- Built an AI assistant platform on the OpenAI API, letting enterprises create knowledge-based assistants that automate internal workflows.
- Optimised image caching and refactored the message rendering pipeline to keep large enterprise conversations responsive.
- Acted as developer advocate for the SDK, supporting external engineering teams through their API integrations.

Junior Software Engineer | Andela | Nairobi

Mar 2019 – Oct 2019

- Developed and shipped features in existing applications, following clean-code and test-driven development practice.
- Analysed source repositories to identify, debug and resolve functional and performance issues.

SKILLS

Languages & APIs: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Java, Node.js, GraphQL, REST, HTML5, CSS3

Frontend & mobile: React, React Native, Redux, Recoil, Tailwind CSS, Next.js, responsive and accessible UI

Backend, real-time & infrastructure: WebSockets, Centrifugo, real-time chat architecture, serverless services, Docker, AWS, Git, CI/CD

Testing & release: Playwright, Jest, Cypress, SIT and UAT validation, regression and functional testing, release validation, production troubleshooting, performance optimisation

AI-assisted engineering: Claude, Cursor, Cline, agentic and prompt-driven workflows, code review of generated changes, OpenAI API, conversational AI product design

Design: Figma, Adobe XD, design systems, design-to-frontend delivery, Three.js, Blender

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Statistics & Programming — Kenyatta University, Nairobi, Kenya

Software Development Bootcamp — Andela, Nairobi, Kenya

SELECTED CONTRIBUTIONS

- Core contributor to Fingo, a Y Combinator S21 neobank, on its React Native application (2021).
- Developer advocate for the ChatSasa SDK, supporting external integration teams (2021).
- Code Day volunteer — technical mentorship and community building (2019–2020).

Client names, internal systems and customer data for proprietary engagements are kept private and discussed in interviews.